

DESIGN EXPLANATION

Social Connect — Mobile App Prototype

A minimal social media application

Clickable Prototype — Design Process & Decisions

UI/UX Design Internship — CodeAlpha

Task 4: Mini Project — Prototype Design

1. Project Overview

Social Connect is a minimal social media application designed as the mini-project for this internship. The goal was to design and prototype a complete, usable app — not just isolated screens, but a connected experience a user can click through from start to finish.

The design philosophy is deliberate minimalism. Many social apps overwhelm users with dense feeds, aggressive notifications, and cluttered interfaces. Social Connect takes the opposite approach: generous whitespace, a single accent colour, one clear action per screen, and predictable navigation. The result is an app that feels calm and easy to use.

The prototype was built in Figma and contains five core screens connected with interactive links, allowing the full user flow to be tested by clicking through the app like a real product.

2. Screens in the Prototype

The prototype includes the five screens that cover the essential user journey of a social media app:

- **Sign Up / Login:** The entry point. A centered logo, labelled input fields for email and password, one primary action button, and social login options.
- **Home Feed:** The main screen. A top navigation bar, a horizontally scrollable stories strip, and a vertical list of post cards, each with avatar, username, timestamp, media area, and like/comment/share actions.
- **Post Creation:** A focused, single-purpose screen with a close button, a Publish button, and a large borderless text area, plus options to add media, tags, or location.
- **User Profile:** Displays the user's identity — cover photo, avatar, name, bio, follower and following counts, an Edit Profile button, and a grid of the user's posts.
- **Settings:** Grouped account, preference, and support options presented as clean list rows, including toggles for notifications and dark mode.

3. Prototype User Flow

The screens are connected so a user can move through the app naturally. The main navigation paths in the prototype are:

- **Login → Home Feed:** Tapping the primary “Log in” button takes the user into the main app.
- **Home Feed ↔ all screens:** The bottom navigation bar links Home, Search, Create Post, and Profile, so the user can reach any main section from anywhere.
- **Create → Post Creation:** Tapping the centre Create button opens the Post Creation screen; the close button returns the user to the feed.
- **Profile → Settings:** From the Profile screen the user can open Settings, and the back arrow returns them to Profile.

This connected structure means the prototype demonstrates a complete journey: a user logs in, browses the feed, creates a post, views their profile, and adjusts settings — all by clicking, with no dead ends.

4. Key Design Decisions

4.1 Colour

The palette is intentionally restrained: a single primary blue (#3A6FF7) for actions and active states, neutral white and light-grey surfaces, and two semantic colours — green for success and red for errors. Using fewer colours consistently is a core minimalist principle: the blue always means “the main or active thing”, so it never loses meaning.

4.2 Typography

A single typeface (Plus Jakarta Sans, with Inter as a fallback — both free and available in Figma) is used across the whole app. Only three weights and a clear size scale (H1, H2, body, caption) keep the interface consistent and legible. Sentence case is used everywhere; there is no shouting all-caps text.

4.3 Layout & Navigation

Every screen follows the principle of one primary action. The same bottom navigation bar appears on every main screen, so users always know where they are and how to move. Spacing is built on a consistent 8-pixel unit, which gives the whole app a calm, ordered rhythm.

4.4 Components

Repeating elements — buttons, input fields, navigation bars, post cards — are designed as consistent, reusable components. This keeps the app visually uniform and, in a real project, makes future updates faster.

5. UI/UX Principles Applied

Principle	How it was applied
Consistency	Same nav bar, colours, and components on every screen
Visual hierarchy	One primary button per screen; size and colour guide the eye
Accessibility	AA contrast, 44px tap targets, visible input labels, focus rings
Feedback	Active states, error colours with text, clear button states
Simplicity	Minimal chrome, generous whitespace, no unnecessary elements

6. Tools & Process

The prototype was designed in Figma. The process followed three stages: low-fidelity wireframes to establish layout and structure; high-fidelity UI design adding colour, typography, and components; and finally interactive prototyping, connecting the screens with clickable links and transitions to simulate the real app experience.

Figma's Auto Layout was used so that components resize predictably, and a shared style guide page documents the colour palette, typography scale, and component specifications — forming a simple design system.

7. Conclusion

Social Connect demonstrates a complete, connected mobile app prototype built on a clear design philosophy: minimalism in service of usability. Every decision — the restrained palette, the single typeface, the consistent navigation, the one-action-per-screen rule — works toward an app that feels calm, predictable, and easy to use.

The clickable prototype allows the full user journey to be experienced as it would feel in a real product, fulfilling the goal of the mini-project: not just to design screens, but to design an experience.